
THE DIGITAL BUSINESS

LAUNCH KIT

10 Things Every Business Owner & Startup Must Set Up Before Spending a Single Dollar on Marketing

A FREE GUIDE FROM

Digital Ninja Technologies

Global Design & Software Development Agency

thedigitalninjatech.com

Whether you are starting a new business or trying to grow an existing one, most founders waste money on ads and social media before fixing the fundamentals. This guide walks you through the 10 digital essentials every business needs before any marketing spend. Work through each one and you will be ahead of 90% of businesses in your market.

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01 Your Business Identity Foundation

Before you build anything digital, you need to know exactly who you are, who you serve, and what makes you different. Without this, every website, social post, and ad you create will be inconsistent and forgettable.

Business Name & Logo

Your name should be memorable, easy to spell, and available as a domain. Your logo should work in black and white, at small sizes, and on any background. If you do not have a professional logo yet, stop here and get one made before proceeding.

Brand Colours & Fonts

Choose 2 primary colours and 1 accent colour. Pick 2 fonts: one for headings, one for body text. Write them down and use them everywhere, always.

Your One-Line Pitch

Complete this sentence: 'We help [target customer] to [achieve result] without [common pain point].' This becomes the foundation of every piece of communication you produce.

Brand Voice

Decide how your brand speaks. Professional? Casual? Bold? Write 3 words that describe your tone and review every piece of content against them.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Professional logo in PNG, SVG, and JPG formats
- ☐ Brand colour codes saved (HEX, RGB, CMYK)
- ☐ Font names and weights documented
- ☐ One-line pitch written and approved
- ☐ Brand voice guide created (even 1 page is enough)

Tip: A brand kit does not need to be expensive. A clear, simple logo and consistent colours are worth more than a complicated design that changes every month.

02 A Professional Domain & Business Email

Nothing kills credibility faster than a Gmail or Yahoo address on a business card. Your domain and email are the cheapest and most impactful first impression you can make.

Choose Your Domain

Go with .com if available. If not, .co, .ng, or your country extension work. Avoid hyphens and numbers. Keep it as short as possible. Register it for at least 2 years.

Set Up Business Email

Use Google Workspace (from \$6/month) or Zoho Mail (free plan available). Your email should be name@yourbusiness.com not yourbusiness@gmail.com.

Create Core Email Addresses

You need: hello@ or info@ for general enquiries, support@ for customer service, and your personal name@ for direct communication.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Domain registered and pointing correctly
- ☐ Business email set up and working
- ☐ Email signature created with name, title, phone, and website
- ☐ Auto-reply message set up for enquiries

Tip: Register your domain name for 3 to 5 years upfront. It is cheaper and prevents you from accidentally losing it when renewal is due.

03 A Website That Actually Works

Your website is your most important business asset. It works 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, never calls in sick, and never asks for a salary raise. Most business websites fail because they are built to look nice rather than to convert visitors into customers.

The 5 Pages Every Business Website Needs

Home (clear value proposition + CTA), About (story + team + why you), Services (what you offer + pricing signals), Portfolio or Proof (case studies, photos, results), Contact (easy form + phone + location).

Speed & Mobile First

Over 70% of global web traffic comes from mobile devices. If your website is not fast and mobile-friendly, you are losing customers every day. Target a load time under 3 seconds.

Clear Call to Action

Every page should have one clear next step: Book a call, Get a quote, Download something, WhatsApp us. Do not make visitors guess what to do.

SEO Basics

Each page needs a unique title, a meta description, and proper headings (H1, H2, H3). Submit your sitemap to Google Search Console. This is free and essential.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Website loads in under 3 seconds on mobile
- ☐ Every page has one clear call to action
- ☐ Contact page has multiple ways to reach you
- ☐ Google Search Console set up and sitemap submitted
- ☐ Google Analytics or similar tracking installed

Tip: If you do not have a website budget right now, start with a simple one-page site. A clear one-pager beats a complicated multi-page site that takes 8 seconds to load.

04 Google Business Profile Setup

Google Business Profile is the single most underused free tool for small and growing businesses. It puts you on Google Maps, in local search results, and shows your reviews, photos, hours, and contact details directly in search without anyone needing to click your website.

Create Your Profile

Go to business.google.com and claim or create your listing. Choose the correct business category. This single category choice has the biggest impact on who finds you.

Complete Every Section

Businesses with complete profiles get 7x more clicks than incomplete ones. Add your address, phone, website, hours, description, and at least 10 photos.

Collect Reviews

After every successful project or sale, send the client a direct link to leave a Google review. Aim for at least 10 reviews in your first year. Reviews are the number one local ranking factor.

Post Weekly

Google Business allows you to post updates, offers, and photos like a social feed. Posting once a week signals to Google that you are an active, relevant business.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Google Business Profile claimed and verified
- ☐ All sections completed including description and hours
- ☐ Minimum 10 photos uploaded
- ☐ Review request link saved and ready to send
- ☐ First post published

Tip: Use the exact same business name, address, and phone number on your Google Business Profile as you do on your website and all directories. Consistency is a ranking signal.

05 Social Media Done Right

Most businesses are on too many platforms and not doing well on any of them. Pick 2 platforms where your customers actually spend time and commit to those fully before expanding.

Choose the Right Platforms

B2B and professional services: LinkedIn + Twitter/X. Consumer products and lifestyle: Instagram + TikTok. Local services and community: Facebook + WhatsApp Business. Tech and startups: Twitter/X + LinkedIn.

Optimise Your Profiles

Your bio should say exactly who you help and how. Use the same profile photo across all platforms. Include your website link. Use keywords your customers would actually search for.

Content Mix

Follow the 80/20 rule: 80% value and education, 20% promotion. Post consistently. 3 times per week done consistently beats daily posting for 2 weeks and then nothing for a month.

WhatsApp Business

Set up WhatsApp Business with a catalogue, business hours, and automated greeting message. This is one of the most effective direct communication tools for growing businesses globally.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ 2 primary platforms chosen and profiles fully completed
- ☐ Content calendar created for next 30 days
- ☐ WhatsApp Business account set up with auto-reply
- ☐ Profile photos and cover images consistent across platforms

Tip: Turn off the follower count anxiety. 500 engaged followers who trust you will generate more business than 50,000 followers who forget you exist.

06 A Simple Content Strategy

Content is not about going viral. It is about showing up consistently for the people who might buy from you, until they are ready. Most business owners stop posting because they run out of ideas. This system prevents that.

The Content Pillars System

Choose 3 to 4 content pillars: topics you will consistently talk about. For a design agency: business growth, design tips, client success stories, behind the scenes. For a restaurant: recipes, sourcing, team, customer moments.

Content Formats That Work

Education: how-to posts, tips, common mistakes. Social proof: case studies, testimonials, before and after. Behind the scenes: process, team, values. Offers: promotions, new services, announcements.

Batch Your Content

Set aside 2 to 3 hours once a week to create content for the whole week. Do not try to think of what to post every day. It leads to inconsistency and burnout.

Repurpose Everything

One idea can become: a LinkedIn post, an Instagram caption, a WhatsApp broadcast, a short video, and a blog section. Create once, distribute everywhere.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ 3 to 4 content pillars defined and written down
- ☐ 30-day content calendar created
- ☐ Content creation time blocked in weekly schedule
- ☐ Templates created for recurring content types

Tip: Your most valuable content is your expertise and your opinions. Share what you know. The more specific and genuine, the more it resonates.

07 Your Lead Capture System

Social media followers can disappear overnight if a platform shuts down or changes its algorithm. Your email list and WhatsApp contact list are assets you own. Building these from day one is one of the smartest things a business can do.

Email List

Use Mailchimp (free up to 500 contacts) or Brevo to collect emails. Offer something valuable in exchange: a free guide, a discount, a checklist, a template. This guide is a perfect example.

WhatsApp Broadcast

Collect WhatsApp numbers and create a broadcast list. Send value-first messages: useful tips, early access to offers, updates. Do not spam. 1 to 2 messages per week maximum.

Lead Magnet Ideas

A checklist relevant to your industry. A short guide (like this one). A free template. A discount code. A free consultation. A sample or trial.

Landing Page

Create a dedicated page for your free offer with a simple form: name, email, submit. No distractions. One goal only: get the email address.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Email marketing tool set up (Mailchimp or Brevo)
- ☐ Lead magnet created and ready to deliver automatically
- ☐ Sign-up form embedded on website
- ☐ WhatsApp broadcast list started
- ☐ Welcome email sequence written (3 emails minimum)

Tip: Deliver your lead magnet instantly and automatically. If someone has to wait for you to manually send it, most of them will forget they signed up.

08 Basic Analytics & Tracking

You cannot improve what you do not measure. Most businesses run on feelings and guesses. The businesses that grow fastest are the ones that know their numbers. Setting up tracking takes less than a day and pays back for years.

Google Analytics 4

Free, powerful, and essential. Shows you where your website visitors come from, which pages they read, how long they stay, and where they leave. Install it on every page of your website.

Google Search Console

Also free. Shows you which search terms people use to find your site, which pages rank, and any technical errors. Submit your sitemap here as soon as your website is live.

Social Media Analytics

Every platform has free built-in analytics. Check them weekly. Look at reach, engagement rate, and which content performs best. Double down on what works.

Key Metrics to Track Monthly

Website visitors and source (organic, social, direct). Conversion rate (visitors who take an action). Social media reach and engagement. New leads generated. Revenue per lead source.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Google Analytics 4 installed and verified
- ☐ Google Search Console set up and sitemap submitted
- ☐ Monthly analytics review scheduled in calendar
- ☐ Dashboard or spreadsheet created to track key numbers

Tip: Start with just 3 metrics: monthly website visitors, number of new leads, and revenue. Get comfortable tracking those before adding more complexity.

09 A Clear Offer & Pricing Page

Vague offers kill sales. If a potential client cannot immediately understand what you sell, what it includes, and roughly what it costs, they will go to a competitor who makes it easier. Clarity is a competitive advantage.

Name Your Packages

Bundle your services into 2 to 3 named packages: Starter, Growth, Premium or similar. Give each one a clear name, a clear list of what is included, and either a price or a starting price.

Show the Outcome Not the Feature

Instead of: 'We build websites with 5 pages.' Write: 'We build websites that turn visitors into customers, typically within 3 weeks.' Lead with the result the client gets.

Handle the Price Objection In Advance

Include a FAQ section that answers: How much does it cost? How long does it take? What do you need from me? What happens if I am not happy?

Strong Guarantee or Risk Reversal

What can you offer to reduce the risk of saying yes? Free discovery call, satisfaction guarantee, milestone-based payment, free revision round. The easier you make it to say yes, the more people will.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Services listed with clear names and descriptions
- ☐ 2 to 3 packages created with pricing or starting prices
- ☐ Outcome-focused language used throughout
- ☐ FAQ section created with top 5 client questions
- ☐ Clear next step on every service and pricing page

Tip: Hiding your prices usually costs you more than it saves. Most buyers qualify themselves out if prices are not in their budget. Let them do that before they waste your time on a sales call.

10 Your Digital Pitch Deck

Whether you are pitching to investors, enterprise clients, or government contracts, you need a professional pitch deck ready to send at any moment. This is not just for startups. Every serious business should have a 1-page company profile and a 10-slide deck.

The 10-Slide Pitch Deck Structure

1. Problem you solve. 2. Your solution. 3. How it works. 4. Who it is for. 5. Your results or proof. 6. Team. 7. Pricing or business model. 8. Traction so far. 9. What you need (the ask). 10. Contact details.

The 1-Page Company Profile

Name, logo, what you do in one sentence, key services, notable clients or projects, team size and location, contact details. This gets sent more often than any pitch deck.

Format and Design

Use your brand colours and fonts. Keep it clean and uncluttered. One main point per slide. Include your logo on every page. Export as PDF so it looks the same on every device.

Keep It Updated

Review your pitch deck every quarter. Update your results, client list, and team. An outdated pitch deck can cost you a major opportunity.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ 10-slide pitch deck created and exported as PDF
- ☐ 1-page company profile created
- ☐ Both documents branded consistently
- ☐ Reviewed by someone outside your business
- ☐ Stored in an easily accessible location and ready to send

Tip: Practice presenting your pitch deck out loud until you can do it in 3 minutes. The deck is a visual aid, not a script. If you need to read every slide, you do not know your business well enough yet.

Ready to build your digital presence properly?

Digital Ninja Technologies helps businesses and startups across Africa and globally design and build websites, mobile apps, software, and games that actually work. If you need a team to execute any of the steps in this guide professionally, we are ready to help.

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